

Lesson plan

Slide;

1. NA
2. Complete starter questions, feedback
3. Learning journey
4. Share answers
5. TEACHER TALK, set up lesson and task
6. Share information
7. Share information
8. Share information
9. Complete reflection questions
10. Share possible answers
11. Share possible answers
12. Share information
13. Share information
14. Complete task reflecting on learning
15. Share possible answers
16. Share possible answers
17. Share possible answer
18. Share information
19. Share information
20. Share information
21. Complete questions
22. Share possible answers
23. Share possible answers
24. Complete plenary

By the end of the lessons students need to know;

1. That Islam has a long history in Britain, stretching right back to the Anglo Saxons
2. That there were connections with Islam in the Elizabethan age
3. The contributions of Muslims to the world wars

What is the history of Islam in Britain?



1. How long do you think Muslims have been part of Britain's population?

- a. 50 years
- b. 200 years
- c. 1,000 years
- d. Over 1000 years

Write down your answer and one reason why.

2. Why do we often think of Islam as a "new" religion in the UK?



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

Unit 6 - What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

Core concepts



Belief



**Worship
and Ritual**



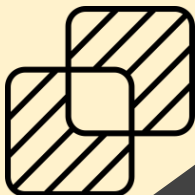
Community

1. What is the history of Islam in Britain?



1

2. What are the key differences between Shia and Sunni Muslims?



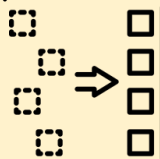
2

4. What is the role of the Mosque in the community? *



4

6. Does Islam align with the British Values?



6

7. What does the future hold for British Muslims? *

7



5

5. Is Islamophobia an issue in Britain?



3. What does it mean to grow up Muslim and British?



3



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

1. How long do you think Muslims have been part of Britain's population?

- a. 50 years
- b. 200 years
- c. 1,000 years
- d. Over 1000 years

Write down your answer and one reason why.

2. Why do we often think of Islam as a "new" religion in the UK?

The presence of Islam in Britain stretches back over 1,200 years. While many people believe Islam only arrived in the UK during the 1950s after World War II, the history is much deeper.

Islam is often seen as "new" in the UK because most people only notice its more recent, visible growth and are unaware of its longer history here.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?

What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Today we're going to explore the history of Islam in Britain.

We will look at 4 key time periods;

- Early arrivals (700s-1600s)
- The British Empire and colonial connections (1700s-1900s)
- World wars and the post WW2 boom (1914-1960s)
- Modern Britain (1970s-today)

Early Arrivals & The Silver Link (700s – 1600s)

- The King Offa Coin (774 AD): King Offa of Mercia minted a gold coin with the Islamic declaration of faith (Shahada) inscribed on it, suggesting trade links with the Islamic world existed over 1,200 years ago.
- Queen Elizabeth I formed alliances with the Ottoman Empire and Morocco to trade silk, spices, and gunpowder.
- Early Presence: Muslim "Lascar" sailors and diplomats began settling in port cities like London and Cardiff.

The British Empire & Colonial Connections (1700s – 1900s)

- As the British Empire expanded into India, Africa, and the Middle East, millions of Muslims became British subjects.
- Soldiers & Servants: many Muslims served in the British Army. Abdul Karim, for example, became a famous teacher and confidant to Queen Victoria.
- The First Institutions: in 1889, the Shah Jahan Mosque in Woking (London) was built. It was the first purpose-built mosque in Britain and became a hub for high-society British converts and visiting dignitaries.

World Wars & The Post-WW2 Boom (1914 – 1960s)

- World Wars: over 400,000 Muslim soldiers fought for Britain in WW1 alone.
- Post-War Migration: after 1945, Britain needed to rebuild. The government invited people from the Commonwealth to help.
- Industry: large communities settled in the "Mill Towns" in the North and Midlands, working in textile and steel industries.

Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

- Diverse Communities: British Muslims are not one single group, they include people of South Asian, Arab, African, European, and Caribbean heritage.
- 21st Century Growth: from the first Muslim MP in 1997 to the Mayor of London today, Muslims are active in all parts of life.
- The Numbers: the 2021 census shows that Islam is the second-largest religion in England and Wales.

On your sheet you have the key information for each time period, with space to complete the practice questions.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Early Arrivals (700s – 1600s)

The King Offa Coin (774 AD):

King Offa of Mercia minted a gold coin with the Islamic declaration of faith (Shahada) inscribed on it. This suggests trade links with the Islamic world existed over 1,200 years ago.



Lesson question;What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question;What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Early Arrivals (700s – 1600s)

The Elizabethans:

Queen Elizabeth I formed alliances with the Ottoman Empire and Morocco to trade silk, spices, and gunpowder.



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Early Arrivals (700s – 1600s)

Early Presence:

Occasional Muslim diplomats and travellers visited England in the 1500s–1600s through growing trade and political links. Abd el-Ouahed ben Messaoud, a Moroccan ambassador, visited England in 1600 as part of trade and political links with Queen Elizabeth I.



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



Practice

What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Early Arrivals (700s – 1600s)

1. Why might a Christian King in England put Arabic writing on his money?
2. What do all three examples suggest about why Britain engaged with the Muslim world?



Early Arrivals & The Silver Link (700s – 1600s)

- The King Offa Coin (774 AD): King Offa of Mercia minted a gold coin with the Islamic declaration of faith (Shahada) inscribed on it, suggesting trade links with the Islamic world existed over 1,200 years ago.
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- Early Presence: Muslim "Lascar" sailors and diplomats began settling in port cities like London and Cardiff.

The British Empire & Colonial Connections (1700s – 1900s)

- As the British Empire expanded into India, Africa, and the Middle East, millions of Muslims became British subjects.
- Soldiers & Servants: many Muslims served in the British Army. Abdul Karim, for example, became a famous teacher and confidant to Queen Victoria.
- The First Institutions: in 1889, the Shah Jahan Mosque in Woking (London) was built. It was the first purpose-built mosque in Britain and became a hub for high-society British converts and visiting dignitaries.

World Wars & The Post-WW2 Boom (1914 – 1960s)

- World Wars: over 400,000 Muslim soldiers fought for Britain in WWI alone.
- Post-War Migration: after 1945, Britain needed to rebuild. The government invited people from the Commonwealth to help.
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Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

- Diverse Communities: British Muslims are not one single group, they include people of South Asian, Arab, African, European, and Caribbean heritage.
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Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Early Arrivals (700s – 1600s)

In the 8th century, the Islamic gold dinar was a widely trusted international currency used across a large trading network stretching from Spain through North Africa and the Middle East to India. It was valued for its consistent weight and high-quality gold, which made it reliable for merchants across different regions.

The reason:

King Offa may have been influenced by the success of the Islamic dinar and copied its design on his own coins so they would be more easily recognised and trusted by international traders. This suggests early England was already connected, indirectly or directly, to wider trading networks beyond Europe, and that rulers adapted their currency to support trade and strengthen economic links.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Early Arrivals (700s – 1600s)

All three examples suggest that Britain engaged with the Muslim world mainly for practical reasons such as trade, money, and political alliances, rather than because of shared religion or culture. The coin shows trade links were important, Elizabeth I's alliances show political strategy against common enemies like Spain, and the diplomats show ongoing communication between rulers and different empires.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



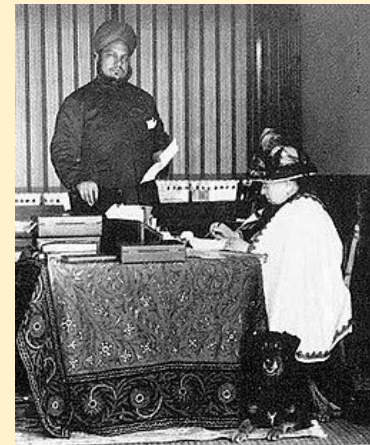
What is the history of Islam in Britain?

The British Empire & Colonial Connections (1700s – 1900s)

As the British Empire expanded into India, Africa, and the Middle East, millions of Muslims became British subjects.

Soldiers & Servants: Many Muslims served in the British Army. Abdul Karim, for example, became a famous teacher and confidant to Queen Victoria.

The First Institutions: In 1889, the Shah Jahan Mosque in Woking was built. It was the first purpose-built mosque in Britain and became a hub for high-society British converts and visiting dignitaries. Before purpose-built mosques, Muslims often used converted houses or rented rooms for prayer, showing how early communities adapted existing spaces for worship.



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

The British Empire & Colonial Connections (1700s – 1900s)

Over 400,000 soldiers from across the British Empire, many of whom were Muslim, fought for Britain in WWI.

Post-War Migration:

After 1945, Britain needed to rebuild and workers were encouraged to come from Commonwealth countries.

Industrial Hubs:

Large communities settled in the "Mill Towns" of the North and the Midlands to work in the textile and steel industries.



Lesson question;What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question;What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



Practice



Turned Discussion

What is the history of Islam in Britain?

In your table groups, discuss how the history we have just discussed (Empire, World Wars, post-1945 migration) compares with how Islam is sometimes portrayed in the media and society today.

Then answer these questions on your sheet:

1. Why may many people not know about the large number of Muslim soldiers who fought for Britain in WWI?
2. How might learning this history change the way people think about British Muslims today?
3. Is Islam something that has been “added” to Britain more recently, or has it been part of Britain’s story for a longer time?



Early Arrivals & The Silver Link (700s – 1600s) - The King Offa Coin (774 AD): King Offa of Mercia minted a gold coin with the Islamic declaration of faith (Shahada) inscribed on it, suggesting trade links with the Islamic world existed over 1,200 years ago. - Queen Elizabeth I formed alliances with the Ottoman Empire and Morocco to trade silk, spices, and gunpowder. - Early Presence: Muslim “Lascars” sailors and diplomats began settling in port cities like London and Cardiff.	
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World Wars & The Post-WW2 Boom (1914 – 1960s) - World Wars: over 400,000 Muslim soldiers fought for Britain in WWI alone. - Post-War Migration: after 1945, Britain needed to rebuild. The government invited people from the Commonwealth to help. - Industry: large communities settled in the “Mill Towns” in the North and Midlands, working in textile and steel industries.	
Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day) - Diverse Communities: British Muslims are not one single group, they include people of South Asian, Arab, African, European, and Caribbean heritage. 21st Century Growth: from the first Muslim MP in 1997 to the Mayor of London today, Muslims are active in all parts of life. - The Numbers: the 2021 census shows that Islam is the second-largest religion in England and Wales.	



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

- I. **Why may many people not know about the large number of Muslim soldiers who fought for Britain in WWI?**
 - a. Many people may not know this because British history has traditionally been taught through a Eurocentric lens, focusing mainly on British and European soldiers and leaders, while the contributions of the wider British Empire were often left out of textbooks and education until more recently. In addition, many soldiers from the Commonwealth were recorded under broad categories such as the “Indian Army,” without their religion being clearly identified, which makes their Muslim identity less visible in standard historical accounts.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

- 1.
2. **How might learning this history change the way people think about British Muslims today?**
 - a. It moves the story from “you arrived recently” to “you helped build and defend this country.” It can create a stronger sense of shared heritage by showing that Muslims have long been connected to Britain’s history. For example, it helps pupils see that families from different backgrounds may share similar histories of service and sacrifice, such as ancestors who fought in the same wars.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

- 1.
- 2.
3. **Is Islam something that has been “added” to Britain more recently, or has it been part of Britain’s story for a longer time?**
 - a. Islam is better understood as part of Britain’s long historical story rather than something recently “added.” Through the British Empire, millions of Muslims were part of Britain’s global reach for centuries. Earlier connections such as trade (e.g. King Offa’s coin), diplomacy (Elizabeth I’s contacts with Muslim rulers), and military service in the World Wars show that Islam has been woven into Britain’s development as a global power over time.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

Diverse Communities:

British Muslims are not one single group. They include people of South Asian, Arab, African, European, and Caribbean heritage.



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

21st Century Growth:

From the first Muslim MP in 1997 to the Mayor of London today, Muslims are active in every part of British life.



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

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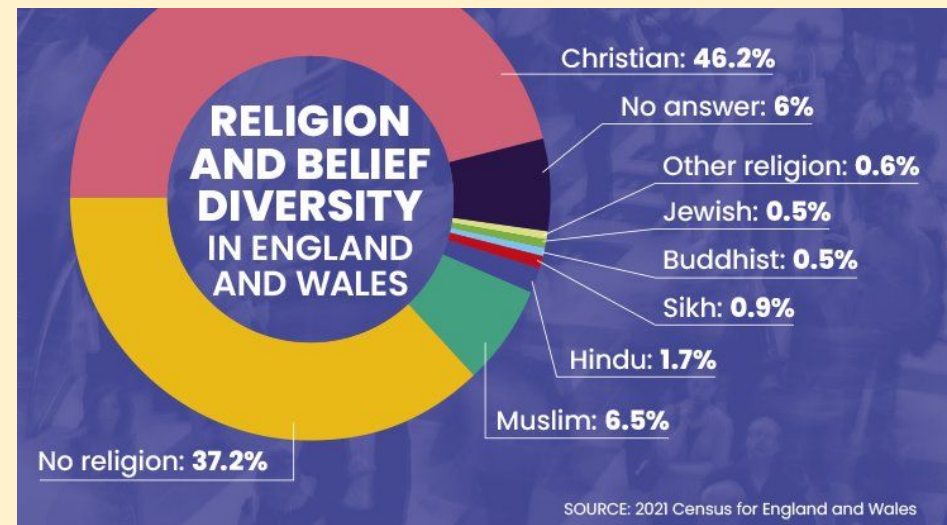


What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

The Numbers:

According to recent censuses, Islam is the second-largest religion in the UK, with vibrant communities in every major city.



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



Practice



Speak For My Team

What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

1. What does modern Britain tell us about how Muslim identities in the UK are changing over time?
2. What does the census data suggest about Islam in Britain in the 21st century?



Early Arrivals & The Silver Link (700s – 1600s) - The King Ofra Coin (774 AD): King Ofra of Mercia minted a gold coin with the Islamic declaration of faith (Shahada) inscribed on it, suggesting trade links with the Islamic world existed over 1,200 years ago. - Queen Elizabeth I formed alliances with the Ottoman Empire and Morocco to trade silk, spices, and gunpowder. - Early Presence: Muslim "Lascar" sailors and diplomats began settling in port cities like London and Cardiff.	
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Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

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What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

I. What does modern Britain tell us about how Muslim identities in the UK are changing over time?

Modern Britain shows that Muslim identities in the UK are becoming more diverse, visible, and integrated into wider society. British Muslims are not one single group, but come from many different cultural backgrounds, and over time they have become active in politics, education, and public life. This suggests that Muslim identity in Britain is not fixed, but has developed and adapted across generations as part of wider British society.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Modern Britain (1970s – Present Day)

2. What does the census data suggest about Islam in Britain in the 21st century?

The census data suggests that Islam is a major and established religion in modern Britain, not a small or recent presence. As the second-largest religion in England and Wales, it shows that Muslim communities are a significant part of the population and are now an important feature of contemporary British society.

Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?



What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Imagine you are designing a display for a local museum about Islam in Britain.

You are give an image to add a caption to.
On your description/caption you should include;

- A catchy title
- The facts: what happened and when?
- The "So What?": why does this prove Islam isn't "new" to Britain?
- The Quote: complete this sentence:
 - "This object changes how we view British history because..."



Lesson question; What is the history of Islam in Britain?

Topic question; What might it mean to be a British Muslim today?